- Advisory

The Court usually entertains those cases that involve legal disputes between states, which are submitted by them for resolution and also requests for advisory opinions on legal questions referred to the ICJ by the United Nations organs and its specialized agencies.

Voluntary Jurisdiction

The Court on many occasions has assumed jurisdiction on the consent of the parties to any dispute and both the PCIJ and ICJ have accepted the limits of such jurisdiction. The jurisdiction will be extended to that extent which will be acceptable to the state parties to the disputes. States which may use the ICJ fall into three categories:

1. All states which have signed the Charter are automatically parties to the Statute.
2. States which are not members of the UN can avail themselves of the Court's adjudication in terms fixed by the General Assembly on recommendation of the Security Council. For instance, Switzerland in 1948 and Liechtenstein in 1950 had access to the Court this way.
3. States, not parties to the Court's Statute, can also have recourse to the Court on conditions laid down by the Security Council. As in the *Corfu Channel Case* (1948–1949), Albania appeared before the Court, which was a non-member of the UN at that time.[20]

Therefore, the Court's jurisdiction extends only to those cases, which the parties refer to it. Though the UN Charter endeavours for pacific settlement for disputes, it does not make it obligatory for members to seek the assistance of the Court in all cases of disputes. Thus, the jurisdiction of the Court is derived from the consent of the parties to a dispute, which the Court never tries to overreach or overstep.

Compulsory Jurisdiction

In the exercise of this jurisdiction, Article 36 of the Statute (para 1) states that the jurisdiction of the Court comprises all cases which the